

HOW A WORD BECOMES YOURS

12 EMOTIONS / 6 FAMILIES / ONE REPEATABLE PATH FROM WORD TO CONCEPT

WORD	PARTNERS	PATTERN	CONTRAST	DIALOGUE	CONCEPT
1	2	3	4	5	6

COLLOCATE Which words prefer each other?	COLLIGATE Which grammar slot does it prefer?	NEGOTIATE Which nearby meaning fits best?	DIALOGUE What would a person actually say?	MAP Which metaphor carries the concept?
--	--	---	--	---

FEAR
UNCERTAINTY / THREAT

ANXIOUS

- COLLOCATE** / word partners
deeply / visibly anxious
anxious thoughts | mounting anxiety
- COLLIGATE** / grammar slots
anxious about + NOUN
anxious that + CLAUSE
too anxious to + VERB
- NEGOTIATE** / nearby meanings
worried = a problem repeats in your mind
anxious = uncertain tension
scared = danger feels present
- DIALOGUE** / make it social
A You seem on edge. What's up?
B I'm anxious about the viva. I can't switch off.
- MAP THE CONCEPT**
TENSION / ALERT
on edge | a knot in my stomach
hanging over me

OVERWHELMED

- COLLOCATE** / word partners
completely overwhelmed
overwhelming workload | sheer volume
- COLLIGATE** / grammar slots
overwhelmed by + CAUSE
overwhelmed with + TASKS
too overwhelmed to + VERB
- NEGOTIATE** / nearby meanings
busy = much to do
overwhelmed = more than I can manage
- DIALOGUE** / make it social
A You look swamped.
B Deadlines are piling up. I don't know where to start.
- MAP THE CONCEPT**
LOAD > CAPACITY
snowed under | swamped
my plate is full | piling up

ANGER
WRONG / BLOCKED

FRUSTRATED

- COLLOCATE** / word partners
deeply / increasingly frustrated
growing frustration | frustrating delay
- COLLIGATE** / grammar slots
frustrated with + PERSON/SYSTEM
frustrated by/at + CAUSE
frustrated that + CLAUSE
- NEGOTIATE** / nearby meanings
annoyed = bothered
frustrated = blocked
furious = extreme anger
- DIALOGUE** / make it social
A Any progress?
B Not really. I keep hitting a wall with the registration system.
- MAP THE CONCEPT**
BLOCKED MOTION
hit a wall | stuck in a loop
at the end of my rope

HURT

- COLLOCATE** / word partners
deeply / visibly hurt
hurt feelings | a hurt expression
- COLLIGATE** / grammar slots
hurt by + ACTION
hurt that + CLAUSE
it hurts to + VERB
- NEGOTIATE** / nearby meanings
anger pushes back against a problem
hurt registers emotional pain
- DIALOGUE** / make it social
A You went quiet.
B That comment hit a nerve. I felt brushed aside.
- MAP THE CONCEPT**
EMOTION = INJURY
hit a nerve | cut deep
it still stings | bruised feelings

SURPRISE
THE UNEXPECTED

STARTLED

- COLLOCATE** / word partners
visibly startled | easily startled
startled look | sudden start
- COLLIGATE** / grammar slots
startled by + SOUND/EVENT
startled to + VERB
startled when + CLAUSE
- NEGOTIATE** / nearby meanings
surprised = something was unexpected
startled = a sudden body reaction
frightened = danger is included
- DIALOGUE** / make it social
A You jumped!
B That bang caught me off guard. It made me jump.
- MAP THE CONCEPT**
SUDDEN IMPACT
caught off guard | made me jump
jumped out of my skin

AMAZED

- COLLOCATE** / word partners
genuinely / absolutely amazed
amazement | an amazed expression
- COLLIGATE** / grammar slots
amazed by/at + NOUN
amazed to + VERB
amazed that + CLAUSE
- NEGOTIATE** / nearby meanings
surprised = unexpected
amazed = unexpected + impressive
- DIALOGUE** / make it social
A Did you see her result?
B Yes - my jaw dropped. She absolutely smashed it.
- MAP THE CONCEPT**
IMPACT / OPENING
blew me away | my jaw dropped
took my breath away

HAPPY
GAIN / POSSIBILITY

PROUD

- COLLOCATE** / word partners
immensely / quietly proud
proud moment | a sense of pride
- COLLIGATE** / grammar slots
proud of + NOUN/-ING
proud to + VERB
proud that + CLAUSE
- NEGOTIATE** / nearby meanings
pleased = satisfied
proud = value from achievement/identity
arrogant = claims superiority
- DIALOGUE** / make it social
A You must be proud.
B I am. All that hard work finally paid off.
- MAP THE CONCEPT**
PRIDE IS HEIGHT
hold your head high | stand tall
a feather in your cap

OPTIMISTIC

- COLLOCATE** / word partners
cautiously / genuinely optimistic
optimistic outlook | renewed optimism
- COLLIGATE** / grammar slots
optimistic about + NOUN
optimistic that + CLAUSE
remain optimistic despite + NOUN
- NEGOTIATE** / nearby meanings
hopeful = wants a good outcome
optimistic = expects one is possible
- DIALOGUE** / make it social
A Do you think it'll work?
B I'm cautiously optimistic. Things are looking up.
- MAP THE CONCEPT**
GOOD IS LIGHT / UP
look on the bright side
light at the end of the tunnel
things are looking up

DISGUST
REJECTION / VIOLATION

DISGUSTED

- COLLOCATE** / word partners
utterly / visibly disgusted
deep disgust | moral disgust
- COLLIGATE** / grammar slots
disgusted by/at + NOUN/-ING
disgusted with + PERSON/SYSTEM
disgusted that + CLAUSE
- NEGOTIATE** / nearby meanings
dislike = a negative preference
disgust = a strong urge to reject/move away
- DIALOGUE** / make it social
A Did you read the report?
B Yes. The corruption left a bad taste in my mouth.
- MAP THE CONCEPT**
BAD = CONTAMINATION
turns my stomach | a bad taste
I can't stomach it

DISAPPOINTED

- COLLOCATE** / word partners
deeply / bitterly disappointed
disappointed tone | crushing disappointment
- COLLIGATE** / grammar slots
disappointed in + PERSON
disappointed with/by + RESULT/EVENT
disappointed that + CLAUSE
- NEGOTIATE** / nearby meanings
sad = emotional pain or loss
disappointed = reality < expectation
- DIALOGUE** / make it social
A How did the interview go?
B I didn't get it. It was a real letdown.
- MAP THE CONCEPT**
EXPECTATION = HEIGHT
a letdown | hopes were dashed
fell short | didn't live up to

SAD
LOSS / DISCONNECTION

LONELY

- COLLOCATE** / word partners
painfully / intensely lonely
lonely night | deep loneliness
- COLLIGATE** / grammar slots
lonely without + PERSON
lonely in/among + GROUP
lonely even when + CLAUSE
- NEGOTIATE** / nearby meanings
alone = without company
lonely = unwanted lack of connection
- DIALOGUE** / make it social
A Settling in okay?
B Not really. I feel out of place, even in a crowd.
- MAP THE CONCEPT**
DISCONNECTION = DISTANCE
out of place | cut off
on the outside looking in

GUILTY

- COLLOCATE** / word partners
deeply guilty | lingering guilt
guilty conscience | a pang of guilt
- COLLIGATE** / grammar slots
guilty about/for + NOUN/-ING
guilty of + OFFENCE
guilty that + CLAUSE
- NEGOTIATE** / nearby meanings
guilt: I did something wrong
shame: there is something wrong with me
- DIALOGUE** / make it social
A Why are you avoiding her?
B I let her down, and it's been eating away at me.
- MAP THE CONCEPT**
GUILT = WEIGHT / DEBT
weigh on my conscience
eat away at me | make it up to her